

VENTRAL VAGAL STATE

Safe, connected, curious
Window of tolerance

Heart rate regulated

Social engagement branch
Myelinated vagus nerve
most recently evolved

↓ increasing perceived threat

SYMPATHETIC STATE

Alert, energised, defensive
Fight or flight

Heart rate elevated

Mobilisation branch
Spinal cord pathway
older



DORSAL VAGAL STATE

Shutdown, collapse, freeze
Dissociation, numbing

Heart rate dropped

Immobilisation branch
Unmyelinated vagus nerve
most ancient